



Core Course in Business Spring Semester 2025

Final Group Project Guidelines

1. Summary

This project is worth 30% of the total grade for the course and requires students to work in a team to prepare and submit an analysis of an entrepreneurial opportunity they have developed, together with an Excel worksheet showing detailed financial projections for the first five years of operation and the expected returns to potential Investors who may be interested in investing in this entrepreneurial opportunity.

The project will be assessed as follows:

Assessment Task	% of Total Grade
Written submission in PDF format that analyses the selected entrepreneurial opportunity, including summary financial projections for the first five years of operations and expected returns to potential investors.	20
Excel worksheet showing detailed computations of financial projections for the first five years of operations of the selected entrepreneurial opportunity, as well as detailed calculations of expected returns to potential investors.	10
Total	30

In preparing your Final Group Project submission, you will work in teams of seven students. While working in your teams, you will be expected to hold regular meetings with each other and make progress in developing the entrepreneurial opportunity you have selected.

2. Description of Task

An effective way to help students learn about business is for them to work on a real-world entrepreneurial project, where you create a business plan for a product or service.

This project is designed to accomplish such a task.

Your team is required to identify an entrepreneurial opportunity for a new product or service and then develop this over the course of the semester, by applying the concepts and tools that you will learn in BUS 101.

Your submission at the end of the semester should aim to clearly describe and analyse your entrepreneurial opportunity to potential investors, who might be interested in investing in your entrepreneurial opportunity.

More specifically, you and your team are required to:

- a. **Identify an entrepreneurial opportunity for a product or service that has a potentially significant market in Kazakhstan and/or internationally.**

This entrepreneurial opportunity can be either “for profit” or “not for profit”.

- b. **Apply the concepts and tools learned during BUS 101 and create a plan to develop your product or service into a viable “for profit” or “not for profit” entrepreneurial venture.**
- c. **Prepare and submit a document (3,000 words maximum) that describes and analyses the key aspects of your entrepreneurial venture. This should include summary financial projections for the first five years of operation and expected returns to potential investors interested in investing in your entrepreneurial venture.**
- d. **Prepare and submit an Excel worksheet showing the detailed financial projections and calculations of expected financial returns, which support the summary financial information you have included in (c.) above.**

3. Assessment Details

3.1 Written PDF Submission (20% of course grade)

In your teams, identify an innovative product or service that you wish to develop (your “entrepreneurial opportunity”). The entrepreneurial opportunity can be “for profit” or “not for profit”.

Using the concepts and tools covered in BUS 101, create a plan to develop your product or service into a viable venture.

Prepare summary financial projections for the first five years of operation and expected returns to potential investors and include these in your document.

Your PDF document will be assessed using the following criteria:

a. Application of Tools and Concepts (15%)

Your PDF document should demonstrate the effective use of the concepts and tools learned in BUS 101 and, as a minimum, should cover the following:

- the problem or opportunity you are addressing and the product or service you aim to develop to resolve this problem or opportunity (1%).
- the business model you plan to adopt in order to deliver your product or service successfully and sustainably to the customers you are targeting, and which supports the market share objectives you are aiming to achieve (8%).
- the estimated market size for your product or service in tenge or dollars (3%).
- the market share you are aiming to achieve in each of the first five years of operation (1%).
- priorities for action, based on your business model (1%).
- the key assumptions underpinning your business model and action plans, that investors need to be aware of (1%).

b. Summary Financial Projections and Expected Returns to Investors (5%):

Your PDF document should also incorporate summary financial data that potential investors are likely to be interested in when considering whether to invest in your entrepreneurial opportunity. This summary financial data needs to be drawn from your Excel Worksheet, described in more details in 3.2 below. As a minimum, it should include at least the following:

- Key assumptions underpinning financial projections and expected financial returns that investors need to be aware of (explanation of breakdown tables and calculations provided in **part a** of the Excel worksheet criteria) (2.5%).
- Interpretation of selected financial results (For example Net Income, revenues, breakdown of operating expenses, cash flow projections, etc.) and financial returns (NPV, IRR and payback) using graphs, charts, and/or diagrams (2.5%).

3.2 Excel Worksheet (10% of course grade)

In your teams, develop an Excel worksheet showing detailed computations and analysis of the financial projections and expected returns of your entrepreneurial opportunity covering the first five years of operation.

Your Excel worksheet will be assessed using the following criteria:

- a. Demonstration of logical assumptions regarding price, sales volume, costs, expenses, capital requirements, etc. Provide breakdowns and calculations of all numbers and explanations of your assumptions (2%).
- b. Projected Income Statement for the first 5 years of operation (2%).

- c. Projected free cash flows for the first 5 years of operation. Assume the cost of capital is 20% and the growth rate for Terminal Value is 3%. You can assume the NWC is anywhere between 5 to 20% of your Revenues (2%).
- d. Calculation of the NPV, IRR and Payback period for your entrepreneurial opportunity (2%).
- e. Ensure all your computations in the Excel worksheet have formulas and are linked to your initial data and financial assumptions. Submissions without links will receive low marks (2%).

4. Submission Requirements

- A submission folder for your PDF Written submission and Excel Worksheet file will be created in Week 16 of the main course section on Moodle. Each team should upload their submissions to the submission folder **before 23:59 on Friday, 2 May 2025.**
- Only one PDF Written submission and one Excel Worksheet submission is required for each team.
- The file names for your PDF Written submission and your Excel Worksheet submission should both start with your Recitation Number followed by your Team Number. For example, if you are in Recitation 1 and you are Team 1, your file names should start with: R1T1.
- Please do not zip your files!
- Late submissions will not be accepted.

5. Referencing and Plagiarism

Students must ensure that they use high-quality academic and professional-standard secondary sources of data in their reports and presentations. These sources should be properly referenced using the Harvard style or other recognized referencing system. Copying material from an external source or incorrect use of referencing conventions represents academic misconduct (plagiarism) and can lead to serious consequences including expulsion from your programme of study.

6. Use of AI Tools

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools such as ChatGPT, Microsoft Copilot and Google Gemini can be used in preparing Final Group Project submissions. However, in using such tools, please be aware of the following:

- If you provide minimum-effort prompts, you will get low-quality results. You will need to refine your prompts in order to get good outcomes. This will take work.
- Do not trust anything these AI tools say. If it gives you a number or fact, you should assume it is wrong unless you either know the answer or can check with another source. You are responsible for any errors or omissions provided by these tools.
- AI is a tool, but one that you need to acknowledge using. Submissions that use AI tools but do not disclose this, are in violation of the NU Student Code of Conduct and will receive a zero grade for plagiarism and may be reported for further disciplinary action.

6. Scaffolding Assignments

To assist you in developing your Final Group Project, your team will be required to submit 4 “scaffolding assignments” during the semester, worth a total of 20% of your Final Grade (each scaffolding assignment will be worth 5%).

Three of these scaffolding assignments will be submitted during the Entrepreneurship and Management module and will help you identify and build your entrepreneurial opportunity. One scaffolding assignment will be submitted during the Accounting and Finance module and will help you build the financial projections for your entrepreneurial opportunity.

The first scaffolding assignment during the E&M module will require your team to choose the entrepreneurial opportunity it wants to pursue and to make a short presentation describing this entrepreneurial opportunity.

The second and third scaffolding assignments during the E&M module will require your team to make short presentations outlining key aspects of your entrepreneurial opportunity, based on the concepts and tools you will learn during the course.

The scaffolding assignment during the A&F module will require your team to submit an Excel worksheet detailing the financial projections for your entrepreneurial opportunity and to make a short presentation on this Excel worksheet.

Further information regarding the requirements for each scaffolding assignment will be provided during the semester.

Completing these scaffolding assignments will ensure that your team is in a strong position to submit its Final Group Project by the required deadline.

Please note that you are encouraged to use material from your scaffolding assignments in your Final Group Project submissions, wherever appropriate. Using material from your scaffolding assignments in your Final Group Project will not be treated as plagiarism.

7. Team Participation

As you will learn over the course of the BUS 101 subject, working together as a team tends to produce better outcomes than individuals working alone.

However, working in a team is not always easy and it can sometimes produce unacceptable behaviours such as social loafing or free riding, where some members of the team leave it to other team members to do all the work.

To avoid the situation where some members of the team do the work and other members enjoy the benefits of this without contributing, we are asking all Teams to include the following statement at the end of each scaffolding assignment submission and your Final Group Project submission and provide either a Yes or No response:

We confirm that all members of our team have made a legitimate effort to contribute to this submission and agree that all members should receive the same Assessment Grade. (Answer “Yes” or “No”)

In a situation where there is a “No” response, we will follow up with that team and where there is evidence that a member of the team has not made an effort to contribute to the submission, it is likely they will receive zero marks.

Please note that in the BUS 101 course in previous semesters, a number of teams identified individuals who did not contribute to individual submissions (scaffolding assignments or Final Group Project) and those individuals received a zero grade for that submission.

We are giving this power to each team because you are in the best position to decide whether a team member has made an effort to contribute to the submission or not.

In making this decision, please be aware that some students may be affected by technology or other limitations which could make it difficult for them to always attend meetings. If they are making an effort to communicate with the team and contribute in other ways (eg through email or WhatsApp) that should be seen as an acceptable contribution.

However, in the situation where a student has chosen not to contribute, and is instead relying on the efforts of other team members, the team needs to seriously consider whether that student should receive the same grade as other team members who have contributed to the submission.

If any team needs further clarification on this point, please do not hesitate to contact us.

Thank you.